Administrative Procedures for

Judge Jarred H. Patterson

I. **Family Law Cases**

a. Hearing Time Pg. 2

b. Final Hearing Dates Pg. 4

c. Zoom Appearances Pg. 5

d. Submission of Proposed Orders Pg. 6

e. Submission of Hearing Materials Pg. 8

f. Cancellations Pg. 9

Family Law – Hearing Time
General Procedures

1. Verify Judge J. Patterson is the judge assigned to the case.

2. DO NOT call the Judge's office to request hearing time.

3. Email request for hearing to Judge J. Patterson's assistant, Dani Dixon, and CC opposing counsel. These requests should be made via email to dixond@jud14.flcourts.org.

4. Use Bay or Gulf County case number and style of case as your subject line.

5. Provide the following information in the hearing time request email:

    a. Type of petition(s)/motion(s) to be heard
    b. Actual amount of time needed for counsel to argue petition(s)/motion(s) – other than matters specified under #6 below
    c. First date movant is available for hearing
    d. Names of attorneys/parties that will attend hearing
    e. You may attach a copy of the petition(s)/motion(s) to the email

6. For the following petitions or motions, hearings will be scheduled for a maximum of these amounts of time (without prior permission of the Court and based on unusual circumstances):

a. Petition/motion for temporary relief	1 hour
b. Petition/motion for child pick up	1 hour
c. Exception hearings	1 hour
d. Pretrials, case management, non-evidentiary motions	15 min per motion

    Final hearings may be set for half day or all day. Half-day hearings are set from 9:00am to 12:00 pm or 1:00pm to 5:00pm. All day hearings are set from 9:00am to 5:00pm.

7. Judicial assistant will "reply all" to the email with available dates, times and instructions. READ ENTIRE EMAIL. Be aware that Bay County is in the central time zone and Gulf County is in the eastern time zone.

8. Only email the judicial assistant to request dates and confirm the hearing date. DO NOT include the judicial assistant in email chains between counsel and/or staff to clear dates (or anything else).

9. DO NOT file a notice of hearing before receiving confirmation email from the judicial assistant confirming that the hearing has been set.

10. Email the judicial assistant a copy of all notices for hearing once filed.

11. Any motions noticed, but not specifically scheduled with the judicial assistant, will not be heard.

12. Additional motions may not be piggybacked on a previously scheduled hearing time without being cleared with the judicial assistant and opposing counsel, and provided sufficient time has been reserved. To add a motion to a previously scheduled hearing, obtain opposing counsel's consent to the addition, then email the judicial assistant about adding the motion to the hearing. The judicial assistant will confirm the addition of the motion to the hearing time. Do not prepare and file a notice of the added motion until receipt of the judicial assistant's confirmation.

13. Address: Bay County: 300 E. 4th Street, Panama City, Florida 32401; Gulf County 1000 Cecil G Costin Sr. Blvd, Port St. Joe, Florida 32456. There are no room numbers – just list as Judge Jarred Patterson's Chambers. Include Zoom instructions (if applicable) in any notices.

Family Law – Final Hearing Dates

1. DO NOT request a case management conference to obtain final hearing dates, unless parties cannot agree on the dates or the amount of time needed.

2. Email request for final hearing to Judge J. Patterson's assistant, Dani Dixon, and CC opposing counsel. These requests should be made via email to dixond@jud14.flcourts.org.

3. Use Bay or Gulf County case number and style of case as your subject line. Include any and all pending pleadings that will be addressed at the final hearing (e.g, initial petition, answer and counter-petition, etc.), and the amount of time needed.

4. Judicial assistant will "reply all" to the email with available dates and instructions. READ ENTIRE EMAIL.

5. Only email the judicial assistant to request dates and confirm the final date selected. DO NOT include judicial assistant in email chains between counsel and/or staff to clear dates (or anything else).

6. Once the final hearing date is confirmed, the counsel/party requesting the final hearing will prepare a proposed order setting final hearing, which will contain proposed disclosure and other deadlines. Obtain opposing counsel's consent to the form of the order and deadlines included therein. If you need a form of the proposed order, contact Judge J. Patterson's assistant to request. Judge J. Patterson will enter the order upon submission.

Family Law – Zoom Instructions

1. These Zoom Instructions apply to any hearing scheduled or for which the Court permits appearance via Zoom.

2. Please be sure you have an adequate internet connection prior to logging into Zoom.

3. Counsel, parties, witnesses, court reporter and the judge will appear via Zoom.

4. Video Zoom connection information is as follows:

   https://zoom.us.j.5239087066

   Dial (for United States)

   +(312)626-6799

   Meeting ID: 523 908 7066

5. Include Zoom instructions, if applicable, in any notices for hearing.

6. All counsel and parties attending a hearing shall do so using video, unless video is impossible.

7. As a video Zoom conference hearing is a court proceeding counsel and any party attending a hearing will be properly attired and behave as if appearing in person in court.

8. So that hearings can promptly start, please log into the Zoom video conference at least five (5) minutes before the hearing start time. The judge will admit you to the hearing from the waiting room. DO NOT disconnect from Zoom just because you may not be admitted right at the hearing time.

9. So that Judge J. Patterson can identify which people in the waiting room are associated with a particular hearing, please set you Zoom user/screen name to your name or your firm's name (as opposed to a nickname or other phrase).

Family Law – Submission of Proposed Orders

1. All proposed orders must be submitted via the e-filing portal.

2. All proposed orders must include a cover letter in .pdf format. The cover letter should indicate whether the proposed order is agreed to by opposing counsel/party or not.

3. **Only the cover letter and proposed order** should be submitted via the e-filing portal. Copies of motion, responses, exhibits, case law or other items should not be included with the cover letter or uploaded in the e-filing portal (see Submission of Hearing Materials, *infra*). The only exception to exclusion of other items pertains to the attachments or appendices that need to be attached to the order, in which case counsel shall either attach such to the order or upload as a judicial exhibit the attachment or appendix to attach to the pretrial stip.

4. All proposed orders must be submitted in Word format. **Counsel and parties preparing orders are directed to remove any hidden formatting or codes**. Failure to remove hidden formatting may result in the order being rejected.

5. All proposed orders must be in DJCMA format (see #6 & 7 below), **but counsel/parties are directed to omit the service portion for the judicial assistant to sign and certify service of the order (the M and A portions of the DJCMA format).**

6. Proposed orders do not need to include the addresses or email addresses of recipients of the order at the end. A copy of the signed order will be served on all counsel/parties registered for service via the e-portal.

7. If the case involves a pro-se party who is not registered to receive filings from the e-portal, the proposed order shall include as the last paragraph (before DONE AND ORDERED) the following statement:

   > Counsel who submitted this proposed order to the Court for approval shall serve a copy of this Order on any party not registered to receive service via the Court's e-portal.

   Counsel receiving the served copy of an order entered is then charged with responsibility for serving (via mail or email) a copy of the signed order on any party not registered to receive service via the e-portal. The judge's office will not mail out copies of any orders.

8. A memo with instructions on submission of proposed orders and the DJCMA format can be accessed at: Microsoft Word - Memo-Submission of Proposed Orders to Judiciary.doc

9. A video with instructions on submission of proposed orders and the DJCMA format can be accessed on the 14th Judicial Circuit website under Announcements & Notices at: https://jud14.flcourts.org/e-filing-proposed-orders

10. Any proposed order not complying with the above instructions will not be entered.

Family Law – Submission of Hearing Materials

(Pleadings, Memoranda, Exhibits, Case Law)

1. Any documentation being used or relied upon at a hearing that a party would like the Court to review and consider must be submitted at least two (2) business days prior to the date of the hearing. This includes:

    a. Exhibits
    b. Memoranda not previously filed with the clerk
    c. Copies of case law, statutes or other citations
    d. Any demonstrative aides
    e. Any other documentation that a party intends to use at the hearing

2. In lieu of sending an email with attachments or hard copies of hearing materials, all hearing materials should be submitted via Microsoft OneDrive drop box. The procedures of obtaining the drop box are:

    a. Any counsel or party that desires to provide hearing materials shall contact the judicial assistant and request a OneDrive drop box for the case. The email request shall be copied to all other counsel or parties. The judicial assistant will send out an email to all parties with a link to the drop box.
    b. Either the movant or party opposing the motion may submit document to the drop box.
    c. Please label the documents submitted to the drop box so that they can be easily identified
    d. If documents being submitted include exhibits for an evidentiary hearing, please premark the exhibits and identify the party intending to introduce the exhibit. Counsel should agree on the method being used to identify the exhibits (such as one side using numbers and the opposing side using letter or using party ID before the number/letter).

3. Use of the OneDrive drop box is the preferred method to submit materials to the Court in advance of a hearing. If it is impossible to use the drop box, materials may be submitted in a hard copy format, to be mailed so that the documents are received at least two (2) business days prior to the hearing.

4. DO NOT email copies of hearing documents to the judicial assistant.

Family Law – Cancellations

1. In the event of a cancellation of a hearing, please notify the judicial assistant as promptly as possible to open the time for other cases.

2. In the event of a settlement or dismissal of a case set for a final hearing, please notify the judicial assistant that the matter has settled or been dismissed so that it can be removed from the final hearing docket, even if there are still matters remaining to be concluded (filing of signed settlement agreement, entry of final judgment, etc.). However, if a settlement is contingent upon the agreement to the form of an agreement, please wait until the language of the agreement is agreed to by all parties prior to requesting a matter be removed from the final docket.

3. Notices to the judicial assistant of a cancellation, settlement or dismissal should be sent via email.

4. Upon receipt by the judicial assistant of the email canceling the hearing, the matter will be removed from the calendar. It is suggested that a notice of cancellation be filed, and a copy should be sent via email to the judicial assistant. Filing a notice and providing such to any opposing counsel or party (especially in the case of opposing pro se parties) is considered good professionalism and courtesy. A hearing or final hearing set by Court order may not be cancelled without entry of a Court order.

Revision Date 1/26/26